

What went wrong?

Symptom -> check first -> likely cause families -> next controlled test

SYMPTOM	CHECK FIRST	CAUSE FAMILIES	NEXT TEST
Collapses at / after lid opening	Proof state + lid transition	Over-proofing; sudden temperature transition	Control ONE branch next batch
Wrinkled + wet / pitted	Lid condensation	Direct drips; plus proof / steam factors	Prevent direct drips and compare
Dense / heavy	Did dough rise?	Yeast / under-proof; flour / structure; collapse	Separate gas vs structure issue
Tough / chewy	Flour + hydration	Flour / dough-strength mismatch; dry dough	Record flour, change one variable
Barely rose	Yeast method + room temp	Inactive yeast; cold kitchen; formula change	Verify yeast, log temperature
Spread sideways / fragile	Proof state	Over-proofing is a strong candidate	Shorten or slow final proof

One-variable rule

Do not change flour, yeast, proofing time, hydration, and steam all at once. A failed batch becomes useful only when the next test is readable.